

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 80

Culture (OWC): [Gikuyu \(FL10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1905-1907

Coverage Date: 1900-1910

Place Coverage: Kenya

Section Title(S)

WINNING THE ORE, AND THE MANUFACTURE OF IRON FROM IT

Yet all the time the spot was an open quarry, in the heart of their own country, situated due east, distant about five miles!

316
[Mining And Quarrying](#)

609
[Behavior Toward Non-Relatives](#)

Politeness and patience, however, work wonders, and when long afterwards they did take me to the spot, the prevarications of the past formed material for many a joke.

316
[Mining And Quarrying](#)

522
[Humor](#)

609
[Behavior Toward Non-Relatives](#)

Those branches of the Akikúyu that I have been amongst cannot imagine a time when iron was not in use: I have made careful and wide inquiry to establish this point. Their folktales too, though dealing with times so remote that the animals are mythical, nevertheless refer to articles made of iron.

316
[Mining And Quarrying](#)

538
[Literature](#)

The population may amount to perhaps 500,000. Every individual is the possessor of at least some iron: a child may have less than an ounce, whilst a man or woman may perhaps hold as much as ten or fifteen pounds in different forms, but all, for use or ornament, have a little.

161
[Population](#)

316
[Mining And Quarrying](#)

The following is a fairly exhaustive list of the articles in use amongst the Akikúyu that are made of iron:—

326
[Smiths And Their Crafts](#)

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)